THE GREENHOUSE
a one-act

by Amara Diallo

(excerpt posted for workshop feedback)

setting: a campus greenhouse, late February.
time: the hour when the security lights hum.

lights up on MOTH, watering dead plants with tremendous commitment.

MOTH. They keep the greenhouse at sixty-two degrees.
MOTH. The plants, not the people. The people
keep themselves at whatever they bring in.

JUNE. (entering) You missed the note.

MOTH. I saw the note. The note was wrong.

JUNE. The note said the fern was dead.

MOTH. The fern is resting.

JUNE. The fern is compost with a sense of self.

MOTH. Compost is just a plant planning its comeback.

JUNE. That is not biology. That is a fortune cookie.

MOTH. (watering) Everything in here is a fortune cookie
if you are hungry enough.

JUNE. I came to say I am not doing the showcase.

MOTH. (does not look up) I know.

JUNE. You cannot know. I decided on the walk over.

MOTH. I know because you are holding your program
like a shield instead of a schedule.

JUNE. (looking at it) I am, a bit.

MOTH. What happened?

JUNE. They want the dance to be about the budget.

MOTH. The budget?

JUNE. We lost our space to a robotics lab.
So the piece is about the loss of the space.
Which they will stage in the space we lost.

MOTH. That is very university.

JUNE. It is extremely university.

MOTH. So what would you make, if no one asked?

JUNE. (long pause) Something with the fern.

MOTH. The dead fern.

JUNE. The resting fern. Something about how it
keeps its shape even after it stops.

MOTH. (finally looks up) Do that one.

JUNE. They will never approve it.

MOTH. This is a greenhouse. Everything in here

started as something they did not approve.

JUNE. It is sixty-two degrees in here.

MOTH. For the plants. You bring your own warmth.

JUNE. (beat) I will think about it on the walk back.

MOTH. Take the fern a glass of water. For morale.

JUNE. It is dead.

MOTH. It is thirsty. These are different problems.

JUNE. (taking the glass) Fine.

MOTH. And June:

JUNE. (at the door) Yes?

MOTH. The showcase is in March. Wear something
that can be watered.

JUNE. (exiting) It is a dance, not a greenhouse.

MOTH. (to the fern) She will be back.

JUNE. (offstage) I heard that.

MOTH. (grinning, lights fade on the glass,

the water, the shape of things keeping)

END OF EXCERPT

(c) sample content for the ObVault preview.
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